37 · The female sexual response, and four words

The words of this track, as it says them. Bold brown is the examiner.

The female sexual response, and four words.

Describe the female sexual response, according to the effects of parasympathetic and sympathetic nerve impulses. Then explain the terms menarche, menopause, amenorrhoea, and dysmenorrhoea.

The last two points on her reproduction checklist. She marks the first one self-directed, and her quizzes barely touch either, so here's her slide, short and to the point.

The female sexual response is similar to the male's. The clitoris and the vaginal mucosa engorge with blood, the same parasympathetic engorgement as an erection. The vestibular glands lubricate the vestibule, at the entrance to the vagina. Her slide notes the nipples harden under the sympathetic nervous system. Then orgasm, the sympathetic part: muscle tension, a faster pulse, higher blood pressure, and rhythmic contractions of the uterus.

Now the four words. Menarche: the first menstrual period, at puberty, when the reproductive hormones first start surging. Menopause: the stage of life when the reproductive hormones decline, and the cycles become erratic, then stop. Amenorrhoea: the absence of menstrual periods. Think, no flow. Dysmenorrhoea: painful periods. Dys means bad, as in dyspnoea.

And a bonus word from her slide: mittelschmerz, the twinge of pain some women feel at ovulation.

Once more. The response, and the four words.

The female sexual response is like the male's: the clitoris and vaginal mucosa engorge with blood, the vestibular glands lubricate, and orgasm brings muscle tension, a faster pulse, higher blood pressure, and rhythmic contractions of the uterus. Menarche is the first period. Menopause is when the reproductive hormones decline and the cycles stop. Amenorrhoea is no periods. Dysmenorrhoea is painful periods.